

Donald Moratz

✉ dmoratz@sas.upenn.edu
in www.linkedin.com/in/dmoratz/
🔗 <https://github.com/dmoratz>

Education

- Ph.D. **University of Pennsylvania**, *Political Science*, International Relations, Methods, and Comparative Politics, Expected 2027
- M.A. **University of Pennsylvania**, *Statistics*, Dual Masters in Statistics, Expected 2027
- M.A. **Duke University**, *Economics and Political Science*, May 2019
- M.A. **University of St. Andrews**, *Economics and International Relations*, June 2013

Working Papers

- "Invasion in the News: Sentiment, Media Coverage, and Signalling" with Sarah Gerstein. 2025
- "The Decoupling of Demography and Destiny: A Zero-Loss Decomposition of the 2024 U.S. Electorate." 2025
- "Tracking Civic Space in Developing Countries with a High-Quality Corpus of Domestic Media and Transformer Models" with Jeremy Springman, Erik Wibbels, Fatih Serkant Adiguzel, Mateo Villamizar Chapparo, Zung-Ru Lin, Diego Romero, Mahda Soltani, Hanling Su, and Jitender Swami. 2025
- "Foreign Influence by Authoritarian Governments: Introducing New Data and Evidence", with Jeremy Springman, Fatih Serkant Adiguzel, Mateo Villamizar Chapparo, Zung-Ru Lin, Diego Romero and Erik Wibbels. 2025
- "#DataForUkraine: Adapting Social Science Tools for Crisis Response", with Ernesto Calvo, Zung-Ru Lin, Olga Olnuch, Graeme Robertson, Jeremy Springman and Erik Wibbels. 2022

Policy Reports

- "Violence Against Journalists and Reporting on Civic Space", with Erik Wibbels 2023
- "Technical Report on the Production of Civil Space and RAI Event Count Data" with Jeremy Springman and Erik Wibbels, 2021
- "Legal Changes and Protest: Evidence from High-Frequency Data" with Jeremy Springman and Erik Wibbels, 2021
- "What Predicts Changes in Civic Space? Evidence from Forecasts in Serbia" with Jeremy Springman and Erik Wibbels, 2021

Conference Presentations

- NPSA, 2025

- ESOC, 2025
- PolMeth, 2025

Teaching

- STAT 5710: Modern Data Mining, Head TA 2026
- GAFL 5320: IDev Policy Research Shop, TA 2026
- Penn Political Science Ph.D. Math Camp, 2023, 2025
- PSCI 6800: Advanced Statistical Analysis, TA 2023, 2025
- Wharton Data Science Academy, Teaching Fellow, 2025
- PSCI 1408: War, Strategy and Politics, TA 2025
- PSCI 1800: Introduction to Data Science, TA 2024

Service

- Editorial Assistant, Political Analysis 2025-2026
- Reviewer, Political Analysis and Sociological Methods and Research
- Pol Sci Graduate Student Organization Co-Chair, 2023-2024, 2025-2026
- SASGov Student Representative, 2026
- Professional and Graduate Student Council Representative, Duke University, 2018-2019
- Master of Economics Student Council, Duke University, 2018-2019

Research Experience

Research Manager / Project Supervisor, *DEVLAB@Duke Machine Learning for Peace*, Durham, NC, 2020-2022

- Managed forecasting process, including driving improvements in **R**, and data analysis to produce reports delivered to external funders, including USAID missions.
- Contributed to the production of research papers.
- Helped transition forecasting process to **GitHub**.
- Helped oversee validation and pipeline data generation team work.
- Promoted from Research Project Supervisor to Research Manager.

Research Intern, *United Nations*, New York, NY, 2018

- Intern with the Division for Social Policy and Development
- Conducted research and data analysis on large datasets in R- including data visualization using ggplot2- on a wide variety of self-reported metrics concerning the status of persons with disabilities in developing countries around the world for the UN Flagship Report on Disability and Development
- Organized and cleaned survey responses from 10 developing countries and created functional templates to allow easier conduct of future research. Used statistical methods to drive insight into trends and relationships.
- Organized and conducted the 11th session of the Conference of State Parties to the CRPD as part of DESA, including providing research, assisting in speech writing, filing reports, taking meeting minutes, and providing executive summaries of side events to be published on the UN COSP website
- Participated in executive team meetings and prepared and published formal meeting minutes and notes related to developing new standards and norms at the UN Headquarters related to persons with disabilities

Other Professional Experience

Financial Analyst I / Financial Analyst II, *Tempur Sealy International*, Lexington, KY, 2013-2017

- Promoted from Financial Analyst I to Financial Analyst II
- Created and provided analysis on a bottoms up monthly forecast and annual budget for roughly one billion in yearly net sales down through EBIT on the P&L
- Developed ad hoc models and analyses to support various functions within the business, providing support to sales, operations, marketing, accounting and other various finance teams using SQL and Oracle, including introducing new methods of analysis such as elasticity modeling
- Revamped forecast/budgeting processes to remove at minimum 20 hours of monthly work through improving both methods of analysis and applying greater Excel functionality reducing time spent on low value forecasting
- Overhauled archaic margin/mix analysis calculations to improve accuracy of analysis in both monthly reporting and quarterly gross profit bridges for earnings calls
- Served as finance lead for cross functional team dedicated to reducing obsolete/slow-moving inventory through profitable channels
- Engaged with a collaborative team to guide the transition/consolidation of finance roles and responsibilities during merger of Tempur and Sealy. Married forecasting and analysis methods from both legacy businesses to drive consistency and accuracy in new processes
- Finance lead on negotiations to launch Tempur branded products on Amazon.com, responsible for pricing, business cases and marketing plans

Research Associate, *Duke University Department of Economics*, Durham, NC, 2018-2019

Market Analyst Intern, *Clark Material Handling Company*, Lexington, KY, 2011, 2012, 2013

Residential Advisor, *Duke Talent Identification Program*, Davidson, NC, 2010, 2011, 2012

———— Awards & Honors

- Penn Grad Talks, Social Science Winner, 2026
- Steven B. Feirson Graduate Fellow, 2023-2024
- Forever Duke Student Leadership Award, 2019
- Duke Economics Student Leadership Award, 2019

———— Research & Technical Skills

Methods	Causal inference, quasi-experimental design, sensitivity analysis, forecasting, spatial analysis, NLP and text-as-data, transformer models, LLM applications, sentiment analysis
Languages & Tools	R, Python, SQL, Git, LaTeX, Quarto
Selected R Libraries	tidyverse, data.table, fixest, estimatr, MatchIt, sensemakr, sf, ggplot2, patchwork, modelsummary
Selected Python Libraries	pandas, numpy, scikit-learn, xgboost, seaborn, matplotlib